49. Prima facie a body should be either constitutional or statutory to wield the executive powers but as a number of Cabinet Ministers as well as the PM himself are directly involved with the PC it wields executive powers for all practical purposes.
50. ***Report of the Fourth Finance Commission*** (with P.J. Rajamannar as its Chairman), GoI, N. Delhi, 1965, pp. 88–90.
51. By 1950s it was a general criticism of the PC which looked highly logical. But through the entire period of planning the Governments never did think to convert the PC into a constitutional body. Practically enough, the Union cabinet and the whole Government is accountable to the Parliament for the functions of the PC as it has complete mandate and support of the Governments of the time.
52. Appleby, ***Public Administration in India: Report of A Survey***, Ford Foundation, 1953, p. 22.
53. As quoted in D.D. Basu, ***An Introduction to the Constitution of India,*** Wadhwa & Company, N. Delhi, 1999, p. 330.
54. ***Gazetteer of India, Vol.3,*** pp. 10–11, op.cit.
55. It is not uselessly that the Government decides to call in Montek Singh Ahluwalia, an economist of international repute to officiate as the Deputy chairman of the PC. Every idea and opinion of Mr. Ahluwalia is today understood by the coalition partners of the Central Government as a thing the Government is necessarily going to implement in future. One can imagine the increased role of the office and the PC, both, by this. There is always a hue and cry every time the Deputy Chairman articulates an idea or opinion. Though the PC is chaired by the PM, it seems that the Deputy Chairman has started availing enough autonomy to speak his mind.
56. It is not uselessly that the Government decides to call in Montek Singh Ahluwalia, an economist of international repute to officiate as the Deputy chairman of the PC. Every idea and opinion of Mr. Ahluwalia is today understood by the coalition partners of the Central Government as a thing the Government is necessarily going to implement in future. One can imagine the increased role of the office and the PC, both, by this. There is always a hue and cry every time the Deputy Chairman articulates an idea or opinion. Though the PC is chaired by the PM, it seems that the Deputy Chairman has started availing enough autonomy to speak his mind.
57. As per the original mandate the PC was supposed to formulate the state plans also. By 1960s, with the decision to follow the multi-level planning (MLP) in the country the states started having their own state planning boards (SPBs).
58. In setting these targets the concerned states were consulted approach of planning was followed.
59. ***Resolution No. 62/CF/50*** (06.08.1952), Cabinet Secretariat, GoI, N. Delhi.
60. ***First Five Year Plan: A Draft Outline,*** PC, GoI, N. Delhi, July 1951, p. 253.
61. ***Gazetteer of India, Vol.3,*** p. 10 op.cit.
62. The Advisory Planning Board (1946) set up by the Interim Government had suggested for such a consultative body with the representatives from the provinces, the princely states and some other interests to advise the Planning Commission for the success of planning in India.
63. Other than the ***Cabinet Resolution,*** it is also quoted is the ***Gazetteer of India, Vol. 3,*** p. 15, op.cit.